Checking Out Items

When you check out an item to a patron, the system registers the checkout by linking the corresponding patron and item records.

To check out an item:

1. Choose **Circulation Desk** from the **Function** list.
2. Retrieve the patron record. Sierra displays any warnings or messages from the patron record. Resolve any issues before proceeding with the checkout.
3. Retrieve the item record. The system:
    - Displays any messages from the item record.
    - Determines the loan rule to apply to the transaction.
    - Alerts you to any conditions that block the checkout.
    - Warns you of any other special conditions that require your attention.

    > If your library keeps certain copies of popular items on circulating shelves for patrons that come in to browse, Innovative can modify your system to not check for holds on those items during checkout. See Skip Hold Check for more information.

4. Resolve any issues before proceeding with the checkout. If all issues are resolved and the checkout is successful, the system:
    - Calculates the due date for the checkout.
    - Updates the patron and item records.
    - Adds the checkout information to the **Check Out** tab.

    Depending on the products and features your library uses, the system can make additional updates at checkout. For more information, see Optional Updates Upon Checkout.
5. (Optional) Select the **Print slip** checkbox to print a due slip.
6. (Optional) Override the calculated due date.
7. (Optional) Add a **MESSAGE** variable-length field to the checked-out item.

Optional Updates Upon Checkout

The table below lists additional updates that can occur when you check out an item. If one of these conditions is applicable during a checkout, the system takes the corresponding action without alerting you.

If:	The system:
The item can satisfy a hold for the current patron.	Fulfills the hold.
The item is an INN-Reach item requested by the current patron.	Fulfills the INN-Reach request.
The item is an ILL item requested by the current patron.	Fulfills the ILL request.
Your library stores patrons' reading history.	Updates the patron's reading history.
Your library stores items' recent circulation history.	Updates the item's circulation history.
The item is a rental item, and your library assesses immediate rental charges.	Adds a rental charge.
The checkout is for a deposit collection patron.	Creates a temporary item.

See also:

- Checking Out Items at Express Lane Stations
- Using the SIP2 Circulation Interface for Checkout
- Check Out with Circa Wireless Assistant (barcode)
- Renewing Items
- Checking In Items

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